FAQs - BPS S&C Portal

HTML正文抽取PDF阅读版

来源ID：SRC-086

原始URL：https://bps.dti.gov.ph/faqs

来源快照核查：2026-11-01；转换日期：2026-11-03

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The iGovPhil Project officially adopts the Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG 2.0) as the accessibility standard for all its related web development and services. WCAG 2.0 is also an international standard, ISO 40500. This certifies it as a stable and referenceable technical standard.

WCAG 2.0 contains 12 guidelines organized under 4 principles: Perceivable, Operable, Understandable, and Robust (POUR for short). There are testable success criteria for each guideline. Compliance to these criteria is measured in three levels: A, AA, or AAA. A guide to understanding and implementing Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.0 is available at: https://www.w3.org/TR/UNDERSTANDING-WCAG20/

All iGovPhil Project services and content are currently moving towards WCAG Level A compliance. Work is being done to make the system fully compliant with this level.

Accessibility Features

Shortcut Keys Combination Activation Combination keys used for each browser.

Chrome for Linux press (Alt+Shift+shortcut_key) Chrome for Windows press (Alt+shortcut_key) For Firefox press (Alt+Shift+shortcut_key) For Internet Explorer press (Alt+Shift+shortcut_key) then press (enter) On Mac OS press (Ctrl+Opt+shortcut_key)

Accessibility Statement (Combination + 0): Statement page that will show the available accessibility keys. Home Page (Combination + H): Accessibility key for redirecting to homepage. Main Content (Combination + R): Shortcut for viewing the content section of the current page. FAQ (Combination + Q): Shortcut for FAQ page. Contact (Combination + C): Shortcut for contact page or form inquiries. Feedback (Combination + K): Shortcut for feedback page. Site Map (Combination + M): Shortcut for site map (footer agency) section of the page. Search (Combination + S): Shortcut for search page.

Press esc, or click the close the button to close this dialog box.

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FAQs

Frequently Asked Questions

What is a standard?

A standard is a document, established by consensus and approved by a recognized body that provides, for common and repeated use, rules, guidelines or characteristics for activities or their results, aimed at the achievement of the optimum degree of order in a given context (ISO/IEC Guide 2 definition).

What is an International Standard?

An International Standard is a standard published by an international standardizing organization such as the International Organization for Standardization (ISO) and the International Electrotechnical Commission (IEC). International Standards generally reflect the best experience of the industry, researchers, consumers, and regulators worldwide, and cover common needs in a variety of countries, thus, they constitute one of the important bases for the removal of technical barriers to trade. These standards are adopted by WTO member countries in compliance to the Technical Barriers to Trade Agreement (WTO-TBT) to facilitate international trade.

What is a Philippine National Standard (PNS)?

A Philippine National Standard (PNS) is a standard developed/adopted and promulgated by the Bureau of Philippine Standards (BPS).

How does one avail of copies of PNS?

Anyone can purchase PNS at a minimal fee from the BPS Standards Data Center (SDC) located at the 3rd Floor, Trade and Industry Building, 361 Sen. Gil Puyat Avenue, Makati City. Available PNS may be searched online through the PNS Catalogue accessible at the BPS Standards and Conformance Portal (http://www.bps.dti.gov.ph/).

There are International Standards not available at BPS Standards Data Center (SDC). Can BPS help clients get copies of these?

Yes, as a member body of the International Organization for Standardization (ISO) and the International Electrotechnical Commission (IEC), the BPS SDC can facilitate acquisition of needed standards. Request letter addressed to the BPS Director is required for the specific standard needed. Order for any standard requires pre-payment.

What time is the BPS SDC open to the public?

The BPS SDC is open from Monday to Friday, 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m.

What services are offered by the BPS SDC?

Information Service – disseminates information on Standards, Technical Regulations and Conformity Assessment Procedures (STRACAP) matters to stockholders. The SDC may also act as an intermediary between the client and international standardizing organizations or other national standards bodies for inquiries and clarifications.

Library Service – serves as a frontline unit of the BPS where clients may purchase PNS and International Standards and a research hub for students and researches for free.

What are the BPS Product Certification Schemes?

The BPS implements two (2) Mandatory Product Certification Schemes: the Philippine Standard (PS) Quality and/or Safety Certification Mark Licensing Scheme and the Import Commodity Clearance (ICC) Certification Scheme. Products covered by the mandatory certification, whether locally manufactured or imported, are not allowed to be distributed in the Philippine market without the necessary PS or ICC marks.

The PS License is granted to either local or foreign manufacturer whose factory and product have successfully complied with the requirements of the PNS ISO 9001 and the relevant product standard/s, respectively.

The ICC Certificate, on the other hand, is issued to an importer whose imported products have shown conformance to relevant standards through inspection, verification, and product testing by the BPS Recognized Testing Laboratories.

What are the types of audit conducted under the Philippine Standard (PS) Quality and/or Safety Certification Mark Licensing Scheme?

- Quality System Audit

During the quality system audit, the BPS, DTI Regional/Provincial Office (RO/PO), or BPS-recognized auditing bodies conduct an actual visit to the company's plant to check whether the company is capable of managing effectively its quality system for the manufacture and delivery of its products based on the requirements of the latest version of PNS ISO 9001.

- Product Audit

Compliance checking

During the product audit, the BPS, DTI RO/PO, or BPS-recognized auditing bodies check the completeness of the inspection, measuring, and test equipment (IMTE), and their calibration certificates. Quality control processes as well as the knowledge, training, and competence of the quality assurance/quality control officers are verified.

In-plant testing

The BPS, DTI RO/PO, or BPS-recognized auditing bodies witness the actual testing of product samples using the company's own IMTE, facilities, and resources and based on the prescribed test methods/processes. The objective of this activity is to check the conformance of the product samples to the applicable PNS and technical regulation as well as to validate the competence of the company's quality personnel.

Independent testing

If the result of the in-plant testing is satisfactory, the BPS, DTI RO/PO, or BPS-recognized auditing bodies will draw samples of the product from the company's manufacturing site for independent testing by the BPS Testing Laboratory or BPS-recognized testing laboratory. Independent product testing is BPS' means of affirming the result of the in-plant test.

What is ICC?

Importers of products covered by the BPS mandatory certification (complete list in www.bps.dti.gov.ph) are required to obtain the Import Commodity Clearance (ICC) before they can distribute their products in the Philippine market. The ICC Certificate and the corresponding ICC stickers are issued to an importer once its imported products have shown conformance to relevant standards through inspection, verification, and product testing by the BPS Testing Laboratory or BPS-recognized testing laboratory.

What are the products covered by the BPS mandatory certification?

Kindly visit the BPS Standards and Conformance Portal (www.bps.dti.gov.ph) for the complete and updated List of Products under Mandatory Certification. The products are classified into three (3) major groups: (a) Electrical and Electronic Products, (b) Mechanical/ Building and Construction Materials, and (c) Chemical and Other Consumer Products.

How would we know if the product is certified by BPS?

The Philippine Standard (PS) Mark and the Import Commodity Clearance (ICC) Sticker serve as the consumers' guide and assurance that what they purchase are certified quality and safety products conforming to the relevant Philippine National Standards (PNS). Products covered by the BPS Mandatory Product Certification Schemes, whether locally manufactured or imported, are required to bear the PS Mark or ICC sticker before being distributed in the Philippine Market.

How to spot fake ICC stickers?

You may use the ICC Sticker Verification System Mobile App downloadable from Google Play (for Android users) and App Store (for iOS users). Simply look for the QR code in the ICC sticker, scan it, and check the result.

How and where to file an application for PS License or ICC?

Manufacturers and importers must submit their PS or ICC applications with complete documentary requirements (complete list in www.bps.dti.gov.ph) online through the BPS' Product Certification Information Management System (PCIMS).

What is PCIMS?

The BPS' Product Certification Information Management System (PCIMS) is an end-to-end online and paperless processing of PS License and ICC, which aims to facilitate ease of doing business by streamlining and automating the frontline service transactions.

How to register in PCIMS?

To register and secure an account in PCIMS, manufacturers and importers must completely fill out the Account Registration Form (downloadable at www.bps.dti.gov.ph), have it notarized, and submit it together with the necessary attachments as listed in the form to the BPS Standards Conformity Division (SCD) or through email at bps.scd@dti.gov.ph.

We were not informed of our liabilities as seller/manufacturer/importer/distributor. Does BPS conduct seminars regarding its Product Certification Schemes?

Yes. Please email bps@dti.gov.ph to request for a seminar or a resource speaker to discuss the BPS Product Certification Schemes on your workshops or meetings.

Does BPS have its own product testing facilities?

Yes. The BPS Testing Laboratory (BPSTL) is located at CMDC Compound, Carlos Trinidad Avenue, Salawag, Dasmariñas City, Cavite.

How much is the fee for product testing?

Please visit: http://www.bps.dti.gov.ph/index.php/product-test/schedule-of-fees for the list of products the BPSTL is capable of testing and the latest schedule of testing fees.

Where do we pay the testing fee?

The BPSTL receiving section will issue a Statement of Account (SOA) and the client will pay the corresponding testing fee at the DTI Cashier in Makati City.

Regional / International Linkages

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